

Denis Tchaouchev

dtchaouchev.github.io

tchaouc@upenn.edu

Updated August 2026

Academic Appointments

Postdoctoral Fellow, Perry World House, University of Pennsylvania	2025 - Present
--	----------------

Education

PhD, Political Science, Stanford University	2020 - 2025
Fields: International relations, political methodology, and historical political economy	
MS, Computational and Mathematical Engineering, Stanford University	2022 - 2024
BA, Computer Science and Political Science, Columbia University	2015 - 2019

Working Papers

“Dividing the Costs of War: Conscript Fatalities and Demands for Progressive Taxation in Interwar Britain”
Revise and resubmit at *International Organization*

“Learning When to Fight: Technological Change and Conflict in the Gunpowder Revolution”
Revise and resubmit at the *American Political Science Review*

“Offensive Advantage and War: A Structural Approach”

Works in Progress

“Technology Adoption and the Risk of Conflict”

“The Opportunity Cost of Military Transformation”

Awards and Fellowships

Hans J. Morgenthau Fellow, University of Notre Dame International Security Center	2025 - 2026
Dissertation Fellow, Stanford Institute for Research in the Social Sciences (\$11,000, declined)	2025 - 2026
Junior Fellow, Carnegie International Policy Scholars Consortium and Network	2024 - 2025
Centennial Teaching Assistant Award, Stanford University	2024
University-wide prize for outstanding graduate student teaching	
Charles A. Beard Prize, Columbia University	2019
Best undergraduate thesis in political science	

Grants

Expense Support Grant, Institute for Humane Studies (\$1,100)	2025
Research Grant, Stanford Europe Center (\$1,000)	2023

Teaching

War and Peace in American Foreign Policy (TA)	2023, 2024
America and the World Economy (TA)	2022, 2023
Political Science PhD Math Camp (TA), Graduate	2022, 2023
Formal Theory I (TA), Graduate	2022

Conferences and Workshops

Annual Meetings

American Political Science Association	2024, 2025, 2026
Midwest Political Science Association	2025, 2026
Society for Political Methodology	2024

Other talks

ISA-APSA International Security Studies Conference	2026
The Future of Artificial Intelligence Governance and International Politics, Perry World House	2025
University College London Conflict and Change PhD Workshop	2025

Additional Training

Summer Workshop on Analysis of Military Operations and Strategy	2026
Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models Summer Institute, Emory University	2024

Service

Undergraduate Mentor, Perry World House	2025 - Present
Co-Organizer, Stanford International Security Internal Workshop	2024 - 2025
Co-Organizer, Stanford International Political Economy Internal Workshop	2024 - 2025
Co-President, Stanford Political Science Graduate Student Association	2023 - 2024
Mentor for first-year graduate students	2022 - 2024

Professional Experience

Summer Associate, RAND Corporation	2025
Associate Data Scientist, Fraud Detection, Mastercard Inc.	2019 - 2020
Intelligence Analyst Intern, Defense Intelligence Agency	2019
Intern, Office of Foreign Assets Control, US Department of the Treasury	2016 - 2017

Patents

Systems and methods for detection of fraud attacks using merchants to test payment accounts.	2023
Patent No.: US 11,775,974 B2; Assignee: Mastercard Inc.	

References

James Fearon (Dissertation advisor)
Theodore and Frances Geballe Professor in the School of Humanities and Sciences, Stanford University
Email: jfearon@stanford.edu

Gary Cox
William Bennett Munro Professor of Political Science, Stanford University
Email: gwcox@stanford.edu

Kenneth Schultz
William Bennett Munro Professor of Political Science, Stanford University
Email: kschultz@stanford.edu